

YEAR
2008

THE REPORTER'S DIARY

FIRST PERSON

Reporter's DIARY



While covering a major story, there are always some aspects which the reporter cannot use because of the focus and the priority of facts and immediacy. Here, we give them a chance to report the side of the story that never got told or was given less importance when the original version was written, from the Mumbai terror attacks to the floods in Bihar and other events that dominated 2008.

The Day the Country Stood Still

By Malini Bhupta

As a journalist, I had always wondered what it would be like to cover wars, but I could have never imagined that the city I call home would turn into a battle zone with all its key buildings falling prey to terrorists on November 26. The raging gunfire and deafening sounds of the grenades will stay etched in the collective consciousness of Mumbai for a long time to come. As news of the strikes spread to the suburbs, where I was dining that fateful night, establishments across the city shut shop and five-star hotels stepped up their security. By 11 p.m., public